

LESSON PLAN

Theme: Speech

Date: _____

Class: SS 1

Time: _____

Duration: 40Minutes

Subject: English Language

Week: _____

Unit Topic: Speech

Lesson Topic: Emphatic Stress

Specific (Behavioural) Objectives

At the end of the lesson, students should be able to:

1. Explain the meaning of emphatic stress.
2. Identify words that carry emphatic stress in sentences.
3. Demonstrate how emphatic stress changes the meaning of an utterance.
4. Read sentences with appropriate emphatic stress.
5. Construct sentences showing emphatic stress.

Instructional Resources

- Whiteboard/Chalkboard
- Sentence charts
- Flashcards containing sample sentences
- Audio recordings (optional)

LESSON PRESENTATION

Step 1: Identification of Prior Ideas (Engage)

Mode: Individual

Teacher's Activities

Teacher asks students:

- What is stress in speech?
- Do we pronounce every word in a sentence with the same force?
- What happens when we pronounce one word more strongly than others?

Teacher reads:

- *I bought the book.*

Then repeats with emphasis on different words.

Students' Activities

- Listen carefully.
- State the differences they notice.
- Predict why certain words receive extra stress.

Step 2: Exploration

Mode: Entire Class

Teacher's Activities

Meaning of Emphatic Stress

Emphatic stress is the extra force or prominence given to a particular word in a sentence in order to emphasize its importance or to convey a specific meaning.

Emphatic stress helps a speaker to:

- Correct misinformation.
- Express contrast.
- Highlight important information.
- Show strong feelings.

Students' Activities

- Listen attentively.
- Take notes.
- Ask questions where necessary.

Step 3: Discussion

Mode: Entire Class

Teacher's Activities

Teacher explains that changing the stressed word often changes the meaning of the sentence.

Examples of Emphatic Stress

Sentence 1:

I bought the book yesterday.

1. I bought the book yesterday.
 - Not someone else.
2. I **BOUGHT** the book yesterday.
 - I purchased it; I did not borrow it.
3. I bought the **BOOK** yesterday.
 - Not a pen or a notebook.
4. I bought the book **YESTERDAY**.
 - Not today.

Sentence 2:

Mary borrowed my pen.

1. **MARY** borrowed my pen.
 - Not Jane.
2. Mary **BORROWED** my pen.
 - She did not steal it.
3. Mary borrowed **MY** pen.
 - Not yours.
4. Mary borrowed my **PEN**.
 - Not my ruler.

Sentence 3:

The principal praised the teacher.

1. The **PRINCIPAL** praised the teacher.

- Not the vice-principal.
- 2. The principal **PRAISED** the teacher.
 - He did not criticize the teacher.
- 3. The principal praised the **TEACHER**.
 - Not the student.

Sentence 4:

We are travelling to Abuja tomorrow.

- 1. **WE** are travelling to Abuja tomorrow.
 - Not they.
- 2. We are **TRAVELLING** to Abuja tomorrow.
 - We are not merely planning.
- 3. We are travelling to **ABUJA** tomorrow.
 - Not Lagos.
- 4. We are travelling to Abuja **TOMORROW**.
 - Not today.

More Examples of Emphatic Stress

- 1. **HE** won the competition.
- 2. She is **VERY** intelligent.
- 3. This is **MY** bag.
- 4. The meeting starts at **TEN** o'clock.
- 5. I said **RED**, not blue.
- 6. We need the report **TODAY**.
- 7. It was **JOHN** who called.
- 8. She **ACTUALLY** completed the work.
- 9. They arrived **EARLY**.
- 10. The food was **DELICIOUS**.

Functions of Emphatic Stress

- 1. To express contrast.
- 2. To correct an error.
- 3. To emphasize important information.
- 4. To express surprise or strong emotion.

5. To attract the listener's attention.

Step 4: Application

Mode: Pair Work

Teacher's Activities

Teacher writes the following sentences on the board:

1. I met the governor yesterday.
2. She gave me a gift.
3. The students completed the assignment.

Students are asked to:

- Read each sentence several times.
- Stress a different word each time.
- Explain how the meaning changes.

Students' Activities

- Practise pronunciation.
- Demonstrate emphatic stress.
- Discuss meaning changes.

Step 5: Evaluation

Mode: Individual

Teacher's Activities

Teacher asks students:

1. What is emphatic stress?
2. Mention three functions of emphatic stress.
3. Read a sentence using emphatic stress.
4. Explain how emphatic stress can change meaning.
5. Construct two sentences showing emphatic stress.

Students' Activities

- Answer questions orally.
- Read sample sentences aloud.

Summary

Teacher revises:

- Meaning of emphatic stress.
- Functions of emphatic stress.
- Effect of stress on meaning.
- Correct pronunciation of stressed words.

Assignment

Write five sentences. For each sentence:

1. Stress two different words.
2. Explain how the meaning changes in each case.

Example:

I saw the doctor yesterday.

- I saw the doctor yesterday.
- I saw the **DOCTOR** yesterday.

Explain the difference in meaning.

Reference Materials

1. F. Ademola-Adeoye et al. (2012). *New Concept English for Senior Secondary Schools, Book 2*. Learn Africa Plc, Lagos.
2. Banjo, A. et al. *New Oxford Secondary English Course for Senior Secondary Schools*.
3. Oral English for Senior Secondary Schools.
4. WAEC English Language Syllabus.
5. Oxford Advanced Learner's Dictionary.

